

Workplace Violence Prevention Strategies

1. Leadership Role

Effective leadership team recognized workplace violence as a safety issue and health hazard. The hospital leaders are committed to:

- Acknowledge the value of safe, healthy, and violence-free workplace environment.
- Allocate resources and individuals responsible to ensure healthy environment at workplace.
- Being accountable for violence-related events.
- Implementing appropriate actions to reduce violence related issues and enhance a culture of safety.
- Participate in the evaluation and improvement of workplace violence prevention.
- Providing inputs on redesigning the facility to improve safety.
- Encourage reporting workplace violence adverse events.
- Ensure appropriate training and education is conducting for all employees.
- Participate in developing policies related to workplace violence.
- Participate in conducting workplace violence risk assessment.
- Investigate and respond to workplace violence related events.

2. Analysis of Workplace and Risk Identification

Workplace analysis is carried out through assessment to identify existing or potential risk. This assessment is implemented by a team of professionals who is responsible to assess risks. Hence, identifying the trends in departments, job titles, activities, time of the day, etc.

Risk analysis is assessing all the hazards concerned all jobs at the hospital. This assessment identifies which specific professions with high assault rate. Therefore, these professions are analyzed and develop action plans to ensure safety and security for these categories.

Employee survey is an effective assessment method to identify workplace violence risks. An annual survey is recommended to be conducted or whenever required. This helps in identifying unnoticed or new incidents of violence. The Health, Safety and Environment unit shall conduct this survey annually.

Patient surveys may also provide valuable feedback about violence. In addition, it may impact on evaluating the hospital performance towards violence prevention programs. Patient experience committee shall include violence section in the patient experience survey.

3. Risk Prevention and Control

After assessing the risks, prevention and control comes in this stage. Engineering plays a major role in creating a barrier between the employee and the hazard. This can be implemented through using physical barrier, metal detectors, additional lightening, more accessible exit doors.

violence victims shall receive all required physical and psychological support from the hospital. This includes counseling and debriefing.

Post-Event interventions to be carried out which includes investigating the event and act accordingly. Workplace violence pathway to be followed (available in the document management system)

4. Safety and Health Training

Workplace violence training is crucial for employees; hence, it is important to ensure all employees are aware about the potential hazards, how to protect themselves and their colleagues from any form of violence. Therefore, the Royal Hospital has designed a special course for employees ' **Personal Safety and Aggression Management Course**' available online to educate all employees in relation to workplace violence.

5. Strategy Evaluation and Monitoring

Workplace violence evaluation is performed by HSE and Quality and patient safety department through:

1. Reviewing reports related to safety and security.

2. Analyzing trends and rates.
3. Measuring improvement initiatives of reducing rates and severity of violence.
4. Surveying employees before and after implementing changes.
5. Monitor compliance of the policy and pathway.

6. Workplace Violence Risk assessment checklists:

The Workplace Violence Risk Assessment is a term used to describe the overall process or method for contains a detailed hazard assessment designed to help either the acute-care or long-term-care workplace by HSE to :

- Identify hazards and risk factors that have the potential to cause harm (hazard identification).
- Analyze and evaluate the risk associated with that hazard (risk analysis, and risk evaluation).
- Determine appropriate ways to eliminate the hazard or control the risk when the hazard cannot be eliminated (risk control).

Identify the hazards

The HSE, Decides who might be harmed or what the impact will be on the organization (assets, environment and reputation) and how, take into account things that have gone wrong in the past and near-miss incidents through:

- Walk around the workplace and talk to staff.
- Map or describe the activity to be assessed.
- The risk assessment may require a multi-disciplinary team to ensure that all areas of the activity or task to be assessed are considered.

Decide who might be harmed or the effect on the organization and how (what can go wrong? who is exposed to the hazard?):

- Consider the number of staff members or patients that might be affected over a stated period of time. When quoting the number of patients affected you should always state the length of the assessment period.
- Think about the complexity of the task.

Evaluate the risks (how bad? how often?) and decide on the precautions (is there a need for further action?)

Consider both the consequence (how bad?) and likelihood (how often?). Is there a need for additional action? The law requires everyone providing a service to do everything reasonably practical to protect patients and staff from harm:

- Identify the current controls/precautions that are in place to prevent the risk from causing harm or loss.
- Use the Risk Matrix Tool and guidance in the Risk Assessment pro forma to grade the risk.
- Decide whether further precautions need to be taken to reduce the risk and if action is required, determine what changes need to be made.
- Check the expected impact of the proposed changes.
- Re-evaluate the risks assuming the precautions (controls) have been taken.

Likelihood	Almost certain	5	5	10	15	20	25
	Often	4	4	8	12	16	20
	likely	3	3	6	9	12	15
	Possible	2	2	4	6	8	10
	Rare	1	1	2	3	4	5
	Risk Matrix	1	2	3	4	5	
		Negligible	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic	
		Consequence					
RISK SCORE = Consequence grade x likelihood score							

Score	Risk Preventative Measures to be taken or planned
(1-3)	Low Risk -manage by routine procedure. Implement any action that will eliminate control the risk .

(4-6)	<u>Medium Risk-</u> Management action is specified. The departmental management must devise, agree, and implement an action plan to reduce or eliminate the risk.
(8-12)	<u>High Risk-</u> Senior management action. The hospital management must be aware of any risks scoring 12 or above and the department management must devise and implement an action plan to reduce, control or eliminate the risk.
(15-25)	<u>Extreme risk-</u> Immediate action required. The hospital management team is aware and are responsible for ensuring an investigation and action plan is commenced immediately to reduce, control or eliminate the risk.

Record findings

Proposed action and identify who will lead on what action. Record the date of implementation.

Review

Update the assessment as necessary Risk assessments should be reviewed in the following circumstances:

- If the proposed action generates a new hazard.
- When a change is planned that could have an impact on the risk.
- When there has been a significant change.
- Following the completion of an action plan designed to reduce the risk (to confirm that risk reduction has been achieved)
- Routinely at least on an annual basis; (more frequently for high risks)